9.3 Micro elements

The micro elements which are essential for normal body functions are Iron(Fe), Copper(Cu), Iodine(I), Fluorine(F), Zinc(Zn), Cobalt(Co), Manganese(Mn), Chromium(Cr), Molybdenum(Mo) and Selenium(Se).

9.3.1. Iron

Iron is one of the most essential micro elements in the body. It plays a vital role in many oxidation-reduction reactions. Hemoglobin and cytochromes contain Iron in them.

Functions

1. Iron is involved in the transport of oxygen by hemoglobin.
2. Iron is essential for synthesis of cytochromes, a component of electron transport chain.
3. Myoglobin is an iron containing protein similar to hemoglobin and is present in muscle tissue.
4. Succinate dehydrogenase requires iron as a co-factor.
5. Iron improves immune status.

Sources



Figure 9.11 sources of Iron

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